

Marshall Middleton

Amazing sounding premium speaker in a solid package

₹31,999

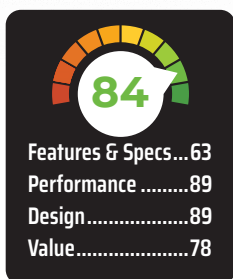


Marshall as a brand has built a legacy over the years of being one of the best brands in the business of making consumer audio products. At Digit, we recently reviewed their two new Bluetooth Speakers — Marshall Acton II and Marshall Woburn III. Both these speakers were an instant hit amongst the folks at the Test Centre and when the Marshall Middleton showed up, we expected nothing less from it.

The Marshall Middleton did deliver on all the promise it was packing. So much so, that we awarded it the Digit Zero1 Award 2023 in the Best Performing Bluetooth Speakers category. The Middleton went past heavy-weights like the Devialet Mania and the JBL Boombox 3 Wi-Fi to claim the crown. So, let's have a look at what makes the Marshall Middleton special and how did it claim the top spot in the Best Performing Bluetooth Speakers category in the Digit Zero1 Awards 2023 —

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Marshall Middleton is a quintes-



sential Marshall speaker when it comes to its design and build. You do not get a lot of colours. Just the good old combination of Black and Golden, which we have come to love and associate with Marshall's products. On the outside, you get the leather finish on a rubberised material, which is again a very Marshall aesthetic, with the branding up and centre.

However, unlike its bigger cousins, the Acton and the Woburn, the Middleton is a much smaller speaker, and comes with rubberised feet, an IP rating, a metallic grill at the front, and hook for the lanyard, which can be used to attach this ultra-portable speaker to a backpack or something similar. As for the controls, apart from the central knob, which has a click and quad-directional movement, the rest of the controls are integrated into the top of the speaker's rubberised finished body. That helps with the overall durability of the speaker, ensuring there are no ingress points to hamper the IP rating. However, in my time of using the speaker, I missed the much more tactile

feeling controls which I have come to expect from Marshall's speakers.

The central control knob is still metallic and retains the tactile feel of the controls we find on Marshall's speakers. The overall build and design of the speaker is solid. It retains the quintessential guitar-amp aesthetic of Marshall speakers. The feet ensure that the speaker stays put, and the metallic grill on top ensures that during the course of outdoor use, the speaker will retain its aesthetic appeal when you bring it back in.

Overall, there is not much to complain about in terms of the build and design of the Marshall Middleton. The speaker is built and designed to retain the essence of a luxury speaker that you would flaunt in your house, and at the same time, also ensure that when you take it out, it is able to power through all that you send its way.

FEATURES

If you have read about or explored Marshall's Bluetooth speakers, then you would know that the brand does not pack all the fancy stuff that are generally present in mainstream speakers in the market. The Marshall Middleton is no different in that regard. In my Best Buy Awards Testing this year as well, the Marshall Middleton, scored the second-lowest score in terms of features, just above the Devialet Mania, but not by a lot.

Marshall has gone, with what I have come to see as a quality over quantity approach. This is a common theme in the products from brands that are traditionally more inclined towards giving the user a better listening experience over features. Their products are not what we traditionally know as lifestyle products. They cater to a subset of consumer who are willing to compromise on features in exchange for great audio and build quality that compliments it.

The Middleton has a few bells to ring around though. The brand has added support for daisy chaining speakers, which allows you to create a truly wireless stereo setup using Marshall's